

A&E four-hour performance

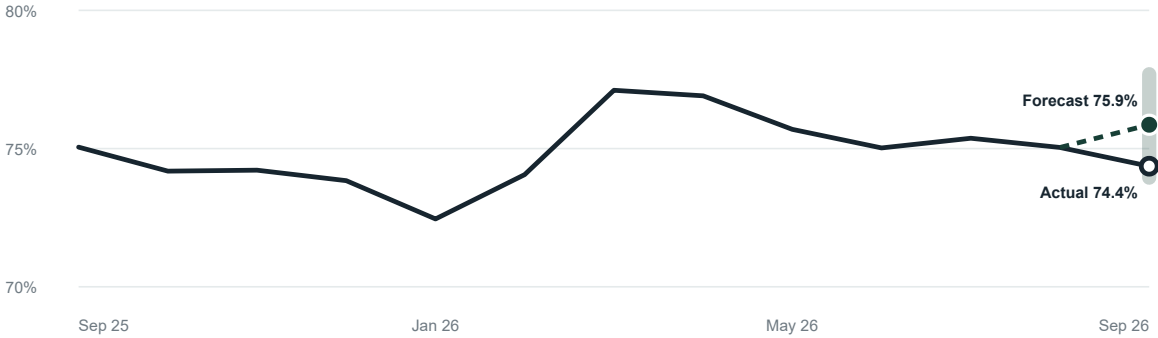
Forecast for September 2026 · data through August 2026 · issued 2026-09-25

The published result was 74.4%, 1.5pp below forecast and inside the expected 80% range. The reference projection reaches 76.9% by March 2027, 5.1pp below the 82% interim milestone.

LATEST · AUGUST 2026 75.0% Baseline when outlook was made	OUTLOOK · SEPTEMBER 2026 75.9% 80% range 74.0%–77.7%	ACTUAL 74.4% 1.5pp below forecast 10.6pp below the 85% 2028/29 milestone
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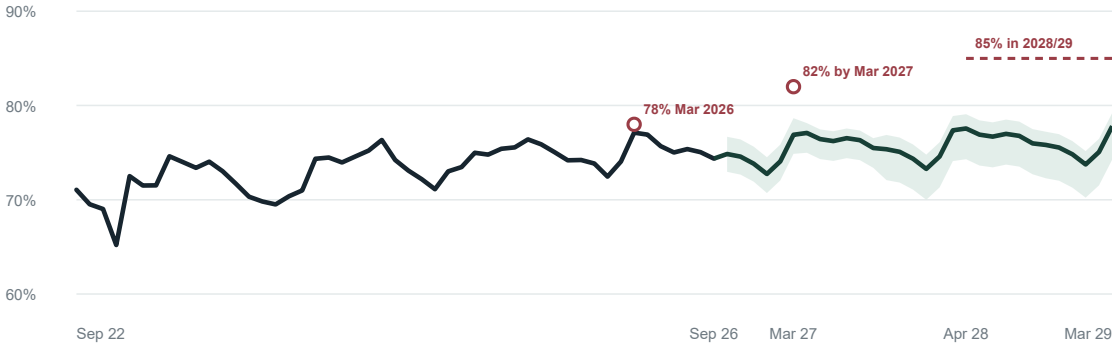
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the empirical 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



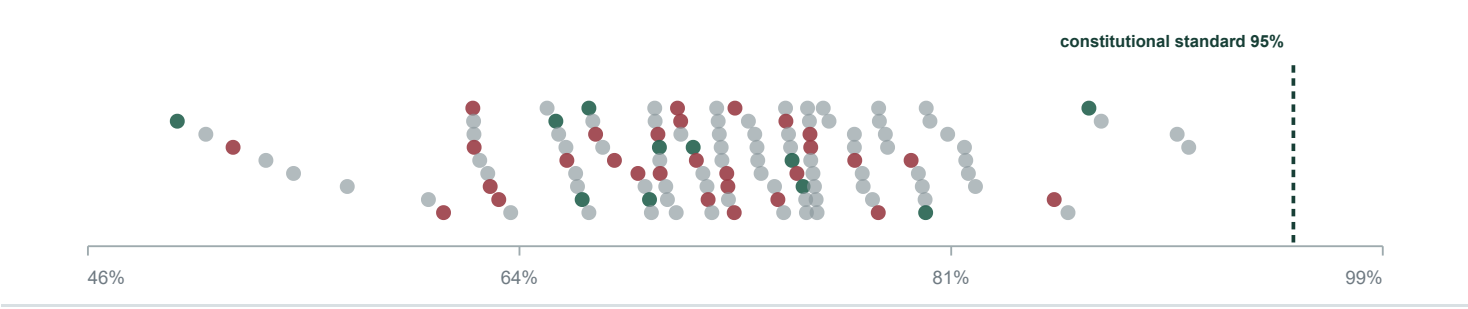
Benchmark: 95% constitutional standard; planning milestones shown on the chart.
Data: NHS England A&E attendances and emergency admissions. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework.
Method: Fixed equal-weight ensemble of same-month persistence, damped annual drift and a shared-season current-era trend, with empirical forecast-error ranges. The pre-release commentary compares the seasonal component with the two trend-bearing components. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · September 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals compare six successive results with forecasts made before each release. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Signals compare the latest six actual months with a forecast path fixed before that six-month window.

120 providers assessed	11 sustained favourable	29 sustained adverse	80 without an active signal
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Sustained adverse signals outnumber favourable signals (29 versus 11). Most providers (80 of 120) do not meet the active six-release threshold.

Largest sustained favourable moves	Largest sustained adverse moves
George Eliot Hospital NHS Trust Latest 86.7% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest +10.9pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual	Airedale NHS Foundation Trust Latest 61.9% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest -9.0pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual
North Cheshire And Mersey NHS Foundation Trust Latest 75.2% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest +9.7pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual	Harrogate And District NHS Foundation Trust Latest 72.1% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest -6.3pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual
Nottingham University Hospitals NHS Trust Latest 66.2% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest +7.4pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual	Milton Keynes University Hospital NHS Foundation Trust Latest 70.2% · 6 of 6 months in this direction · Continuing 1 archived + historical backtest -5.5pp SIX-MONTH GAP Historically unusual

Trajectory-watch rule. The latest 6 actual months are compared with a path fixed before that window. The average gap must be at least 2.0pp, at least 5 of 6 months must point in the same direction, and the latest month must confirm it. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.